

DATE(1)	User Commands	DATE(1)
NAME		
date - print or set the system date and time		
SYNOPSIS		
date [OPTION]... [+FORMAT]		
date [-u --utc --universal] [MMDDhhmm[[CC]YY][.ss]]		
DESCRIPTION		
Display the current time in the given FORMAT, or set the system date.		
Mandatory arguments to long options are mandatory for short options too.		
-d, --date=STRING		
display time described by STRING, not 'now'		
--debug		
annotate the parsed date, and warn about questionable usage to stderr		
-f, --file=DATEFILE		
like --date; once for each line of DATEFILE		
-I[FMT], --iso-8601[=FMT]		
output date/time in ISO 8601 format. FMT='date' for date only (the default), 'hours', 'minutes', 'seconds', or 'ns' for date and time to the indicated precision. Example: 2006-08-14T02:34:56-06:00		
-R, --rfc-email		
output date and time in RFC 5322 format. Example: Mon, 14 Aug 2006 02:34:56 -0600		

Figure 1: Manual of *date* command

Redirection operators

The redirection operator is really useful when you want to capture the output of a command in a file or redirect to a file.

\$ls -l /usr/bin >file	default stdout to file
\$ls -l /usr/bin 2>file	redirects stderr to file
\$ls -l /usr/bin > ls-output 2>&1	redirects stderr & stdout to file
\$ls -l /usr/bin &> ls-output	redirects stderr & stdout to file
\$ls -l /usr/bin 2> /dev/null	/dev/null bitbucket

Brace expansion

Brace expansion is one of the powerful options UNIX has. It helps do a lot of operations with minimal commands in a single line instruction. For example:

```
$echo Front-{A,B,C}-Back
```

```
Front-A-Back, Front-B-Back, Front-C-Back
```

```
$echo {Z..A}
Z Y X W V U T S R Q P O N M L K J I H G F E D C B A
```

```
$mkdir {2009..2011}-0{1..9} {2009..2011}-{10..12}
```

This creates a directory for 12 months from 2009 to 2011.

Environment variables

An environment variable is a dynamic-named value that can affect the way running processes will behave on a computer. This variable is a part of the environment in which a process runs.

printenv	Print part of all of the environment
set	set shell options
export	export environment to subsequently executed programs
alias	create an alias for command